

LEAF & LET DIE

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Prototype Rulebook — Revision v36 (01)

2-4 players • 90-120 minutes • Ages 13+



Grow Your Plant Creature.

Prove Your Worth in Battle!

BLIND PLAYTEST RULEBOOK

Use this version for testing comprehension, turn flow, and player-facing rule lookup.

*PLAYTEST DISCLAIMER: This document is for prototype playtesting only.
Artwork, icons, graphic design, and exact layout remain temporary.*

GAME OVERVIEW

Deep in the forest, your gnome colony gathers in a sacred grove to determine the next **Guardian of the Grove**. With enchanted accelerants, a living Plant Creature can be called forth in minutes — Roots tunneling, Vines surging, Flowers blooming with strange powers—then hurled into ceremonial combat.

You are one of the contenders. You'll build a unique Plant Creature on your **Plant Core** by grafting **Roots, Vines, and Flowers**. From the **Grove**—the shared pool of cards, dice, and tokens—you'll claim new growth and stronger dice as the game unfolds.

Your **dice** are your raw surge of power; your cards are how you shape it—nudging luck, setting up clever turns, and keeping your Creature battle-ready. When your energy fades—those low dice rolls—you draw in shy helpers from the undergrowth, gaining **Critters** and **Wisps**.

OVERVIEW

GROW. BATTLE ON COMMAND.

The game cycles through groups of **Cultivation** Rounds, each followed by a **Battle** Round. During Cultivation, grow your Plant Creature. During Battle, put your Creature to the test by competing in Strikes. After the final Battle Round, proceed to final scoring.

THE PLAYER WITH THE MOST VICTORY POINTS (VP) WINS.

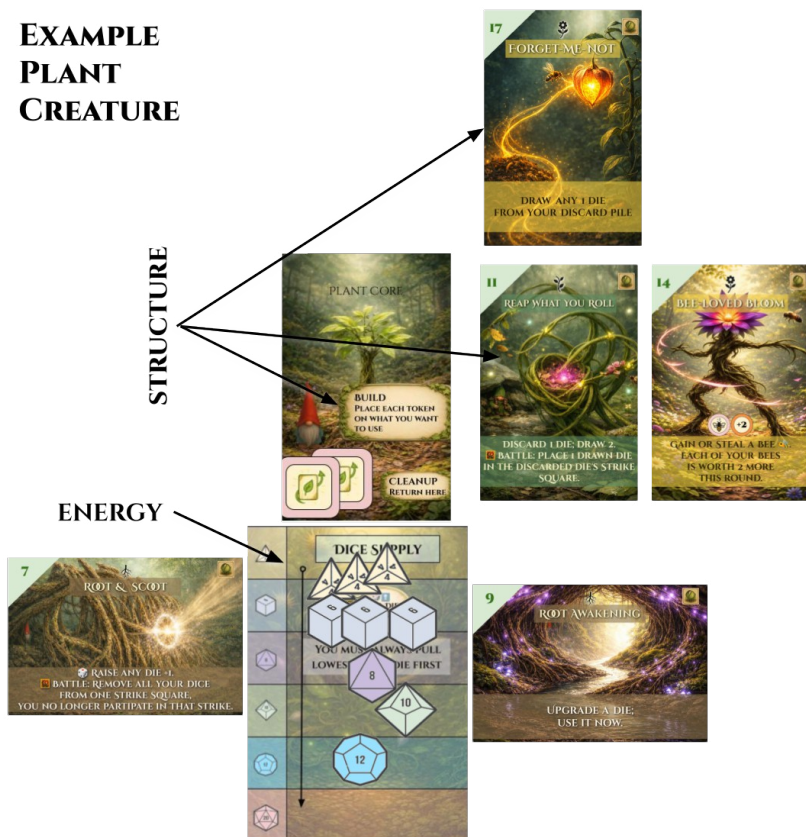
You earn Victory Points in three primary ways:

- **Grow your Plant Creature.** At the end of the game, score the VP printed on each Plant card grafted to it.
- **Win Strikes in Battle.** Gain VP tokens for winning Strikes.
- **Keep Wisps.** At the end of the game, score the VP printed on each unplayed Wisp.

YOUR PLANT CREATURE: STRUCTURE AND ENERGY

CARDS ARE STRUCTURE; DICE ARE ENERGY.

EXAMPLE PLANT CREATURE



COMPONENTS

Plant Cards (216)

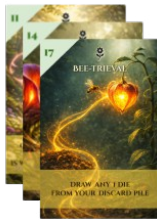
Root Cards (72)



Vine Cards (72)



Flower Cards (72)



Cultivation Round Cards (12)



Helper Mat



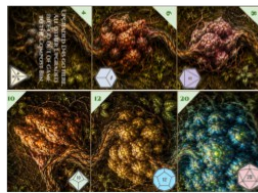
Graft Bed Dice (45) - 9 each



Battle Round Cards (6)



Graft Bed



Critters (18)



Wisp Cards (32)



Water Tokens (9)



Mulch Tokens (9)

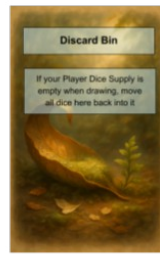


Butterfly Tokens (4)



Player Components

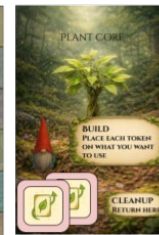
Discard Bin (4)



Player Dice Supply (4)



Plant Core (4)



Gnomes (4)



Starting Dice (24)



Main Action Tokens (8)



Battle Glade



Victory Tokens (25 1-VP, 8 5-VP)



CARD AND COMPONENT KEY

PLANT CARDS



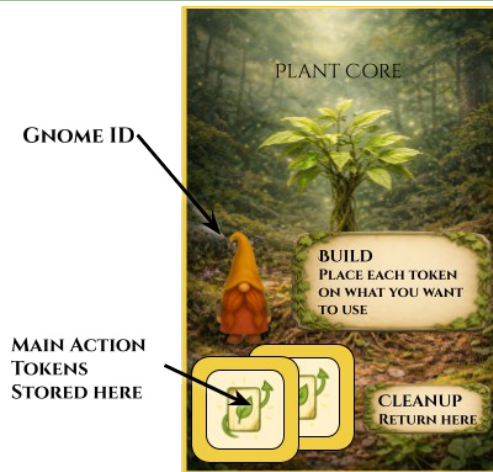
ROUND CARDS



WISP CARDS



PLANT CORE



HELPERS & TOKENS



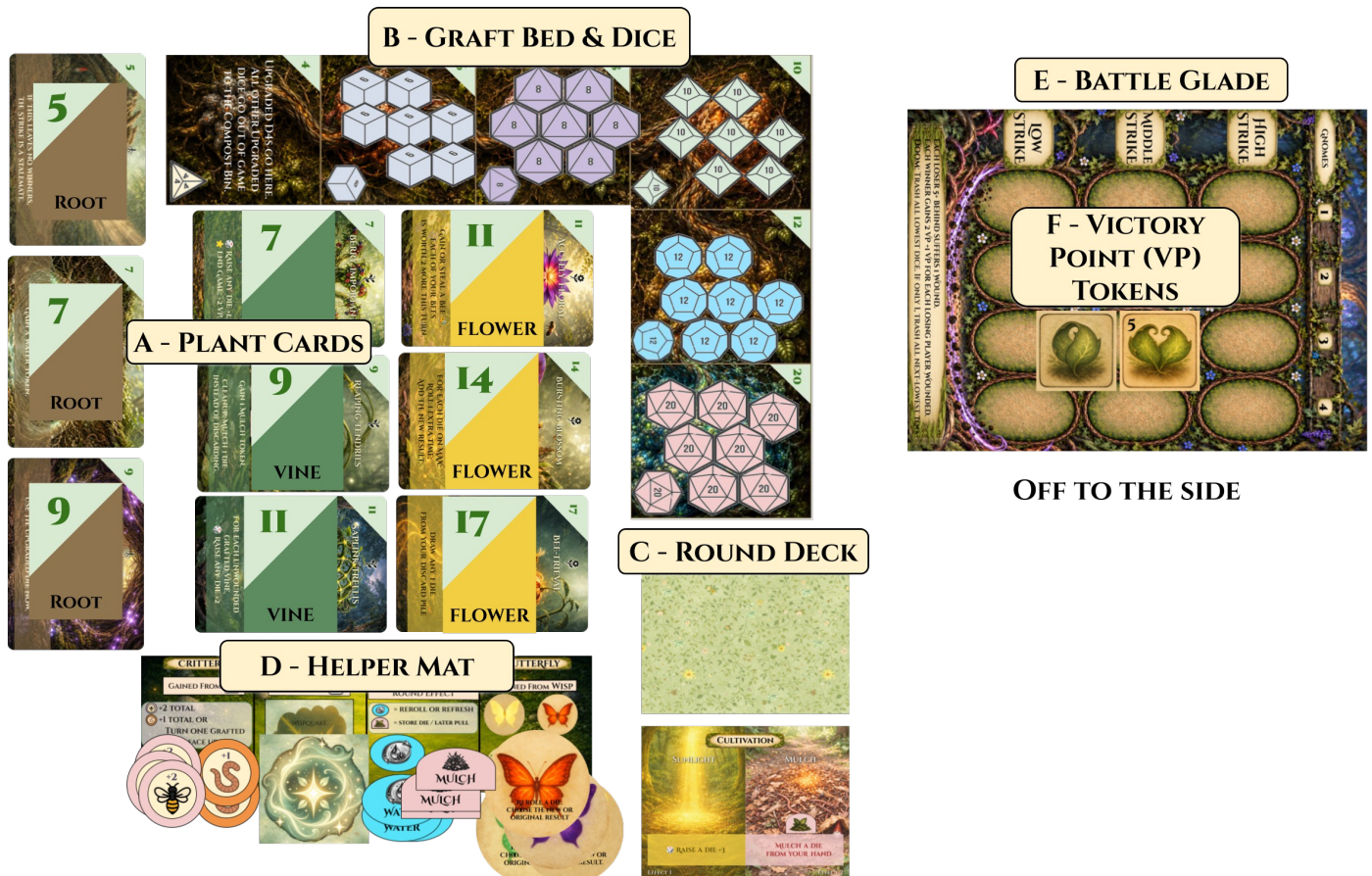
Worms, Bees, Water, Mulch, and Butterflies have their own effects; during Battle, using many of them counts as a Support Action.

The Graft Bed and Helper Mat are both part of the Grove.

Graft Bed: Holds the dice available to buy and shows their costs.

Helper Mat: Holds the shared Critters, tokens, Butterflies, and Wisp deck.

GROVE SETUP



Arrange the shared Grove as shown.

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A — PLANT CARDS

Create 9 face-up Plant Card stacks in the Grove: 3 Root, 3 Vine, 3 Flower. **Each stack should contain all copies of that card name.**

For your first game, use the following recommended cards:

Roots	Vines	Flowers
⑤ Root Four More	⑦ Berry Important	⑪ Sapping Snapdragon
⑦ Root Recall	⑨ Low & Behold	⑭ Bloom Backflip
⑨ Root Kindred	⑪ Vine's the Limit	⑰ Queen's Blossom

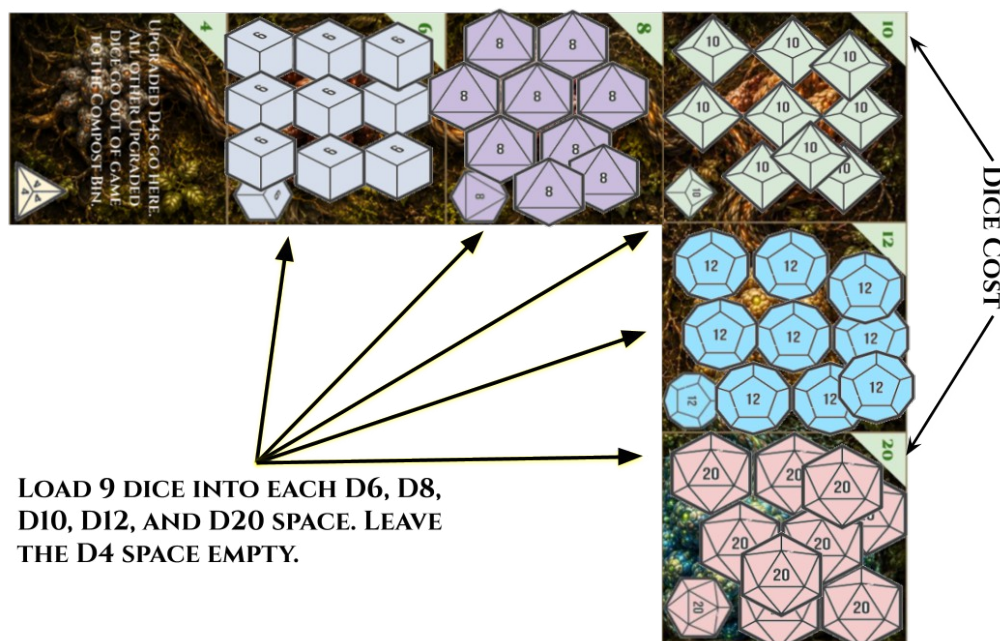
Random Grove — Later Games

After your first game, you may randomly choose one card that matches the listed type and cost. Place all copies of each card in a face-up stack.

Roots	Vines	Flowers
one ⑤ Root card	one ⑦ Vine card	one ⑪ Flower card
one ⑦ Root card	one ⑨ Vine card	one ⑭ Flower card
one ⑨ Root card	one ⑪ Vine card	one ⑰ Flower card



B — GRAFT BED AND DICE



Load each D6, D8, D10, D12, and D20 space on the Graft Bed with 9 dice.

Leave the D4 space empty.

The D4 space is a return space, not a normal dice supply. During the game, replaced D4s go there when they are upgraded. Replaced dice of any other size go out of the game and back into the box.

C — ROUND DECK

Standard Starting Setup — 2/2/3

Create a 10-card Round Deck:

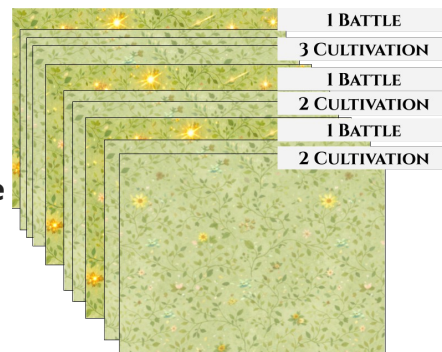
- Shuffle separately the 6 Battle Round Cards and the 12 Cultivation Round Cards.
- Deal out cards from each deck to create a single round deck in this order:

2 Cultivation → 1 Battle → 2 Cultivation → 1 Battle → 3 Cultivation → 1 Battle

The numbers 2/2/3 indicate how many Cultivation Rounds occur before each Battle Round. Keep all cards face down until they are revealed during play.

See Variants on page 19 for other game lengths and Round Deck arrangements.

Return all unused Round Cards to the box. The game ends after the final Round Card is resolved. Leave space beside the deck for the currently revealed Round Card.



Only at the Elders' signal may the Gnomes unleash their Plant Creatures into Battle!

D — HELPER MAT



Place Worms, Bees, Water, Mulch, and Butterflies in their matching shared spaces on the Helper Mat. Shuffle the Wisp deck and place it face down on the Helper Mat.

E — BATTLE GLADE

Keep the Battle Glade beside the Grove. It will be placed in the center when a Battle Round occurs.



**STRIKE ROW:
HIGHEST TOTAL WINS**

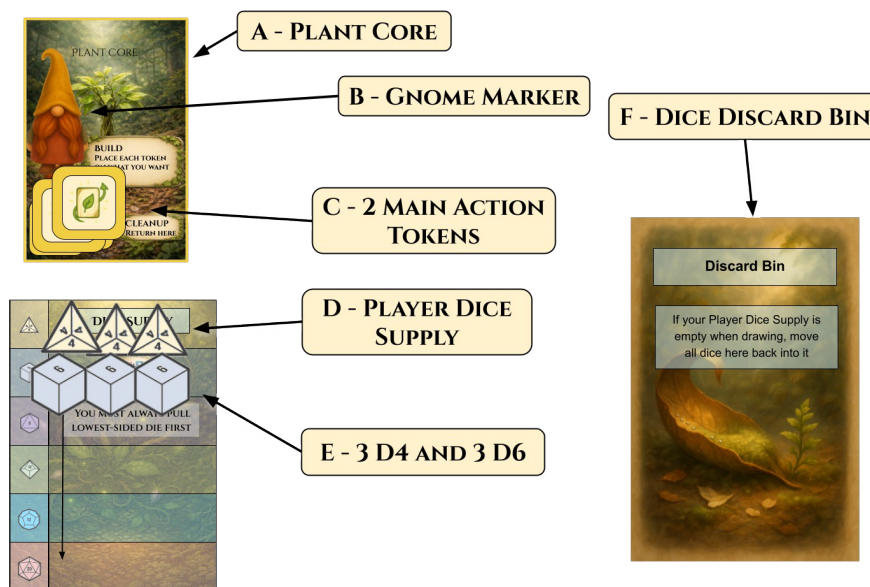
During Battle, your dice are placed on the **Battle Glade**. Each horizontal row is a **Strike**. Use your **Plant Creature**, **Critters**, and other effects to strengthen your position. The highest total in each Strike wins **2 VP**; falling **5 or more behind** can cause a **Wound**.

F — VICTORY POINT (VP) TOKENS

Place the VP tokens near the Grove.

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SET UP EACH PLAYER AREA



Each player takes:

- A — Plant Core: Leave room above and to both sides for your Plant Creature to grow.
- B — Gnome: Place on the Plant Core.
- C — Main Action Tokens: Place both on the Plant Core.
- D — Player Dice Supply
- E — Starting Dice: Put 3D4 + 3D6 in your Supply, with the D4s sorted above the D6s.
- F — Dice Discard Bin

Leave the indicated space between the Supply and Discard Bin as your Dice Hand.

LEARN AS YOU PLAY

For your first game, follow the next sections as you play. They explain what to do and introduce each system when you first need it. Read the Battle section when the first Battle Round Card is revealed. The Almanac is optional reference material.

CULTIVATION ROUND

CULTIVATION ROUND AT A GLANCE



During Cultivation, all players perform Draw & Roll and Build simultaneously. During Buy, players act in Buy Order.

The Big Idea

Each Cultivation Round, first roll 3 dice to form your Dice Hand. Those dice stay in your Hand as you move through the round; do not roll them again unless an action or effect tells you to. Then use your 2 Main Actions to draw another die, activate Plant cards, or use either Round Effect. Finally, spend dice and Critters to buy new dice and Plant cards. Spent dice go to your Dice Discard Bin; at Cleanup, any dice still in your Hand go there too.

How to Read These Rules

GREEN BOXES = RULES AT A GLANCE.

Green boxes state the rule for that section at a glance. When needed, additional text provides details, examples, and special cases.

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STEP 1 — REVEAL

REVEAL. FOLLOW ITS TYPE.

Reveal the next Round Card.

Cultivation: Both Round Effects are available during Build. Continue to Step 2.

Battle: Continue with Battle, Step 2.

Cultivation Round Effects are Sunlight, Water, Mulch, or Compost. Elaborated on page 11 below.

STEP 2 — DRAW AND ROLL (SIMULTANEOUS)

DRAW 3, LOWEST FIRST. REFILL ONLY WHEN NEEDED.

All players *simultaneously* draw and roll 3 dice, always taking the lowest-sided available die first. If your Player Dice Supply is empty when you need to Draw, refill it from your Dice Discard Bin and continue drawing.

In the first round, your first 3 dice are always your **3 D4s**.

To Draw a die, take it from your **Player Dice Supply**, roll it, and place it in your **Dice Hand** —the rolled dice available to you this round

Resolve each **Roll Reward** immediately after rolling (*explained below*).

Player Dice Supply: dice waiting to be drawn.

Dice Hand: the rolled dice available to you this round. The total of your dice and Critters determines your purchasing power and, during Battle, your attack strength.

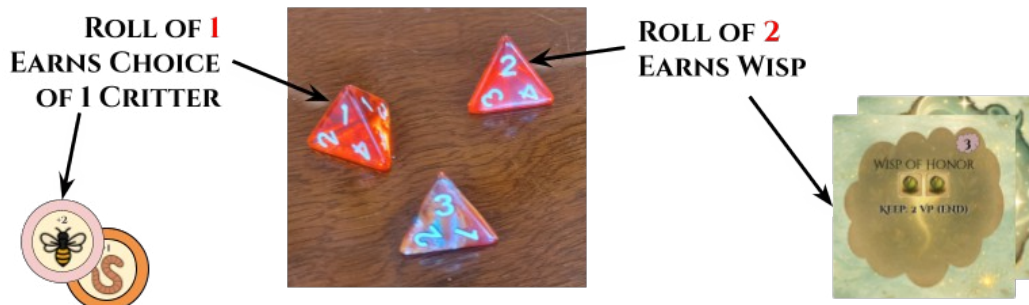
At **Cleanup** (*explained later*), spent dice and dice remaining in your Hand go to your **Dice Discard Bin**.



ROLL REWARDS

1 = CRITTER. 2 = WISP.

After any die roll, immediately gain a Critter for a 1 or a Wisp for a 2. **Keep the die.**



Resolve Roll Rewards immediately after any roll, including effect rerolls, unless the effect specifically says to ignore Roll Rewards. Any die size can earn a Roll Reward.

*Tip: For your first game, choose a **Bee** for the first few Critter rewards.*

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Step 2 is now complete. Everyone leaves their rolled dice in their Dice Hand.

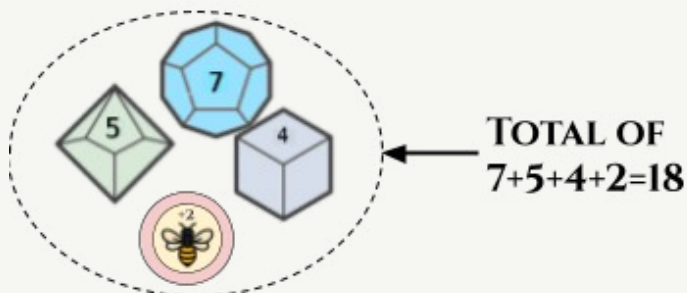
CRITTERS

BEE +2; WORM +1 OR FLIP.

Critters do not change a die face.

Keep them until used, then return them to the Grove.

Bee



Spend a Bee for +2 to a purchase total during Buy, or a Strike total during Battle.

Worm



Spend a Worm for +1 to a purchase total during Buy, or a Strike total during Battle, or spend it to Flip 1 grafted Plant card.

WISPS

PLAY, RESOLVE, TRASH.

Play a Wisp during the Cultivation's Build phase. During Battle, playing a Wisp is a Support Action. Resolve its effect, then Trash it. Unplayed Wisps score their printed VP at game end.

If you gain the last Wisp, resolve Wispquake shown on the Helper Mat immediately. This is rare. See Wispquake in the Almanac.

IF A WISP GIVES YOU A BUTTERFLY

REROLL, FLIP, REFRESH.

Use — Reroll 1 of your dice; keep either result. Then flip the Butterfly face down.

Refresh — Flip it face up when your Plant Creature Refreshes.

Battle — Using a Butterfly is a Support Action.

Getting Butterflies: Pollinating Wisps award the matching-color Butterfly. Place it face up anywhere near your Plant Creature; its exact position does not matter. If you already own it, Refresh it instead. If another player gains it, it moves to them.

Roll Rewards: A Butterfly reroll earns a Roll Reward only if you keep a different new result of 1 or 2. Keeping the original result if it was a 1 or 2 does not earn another Roll Reward.



CULTIVATION: USE ANYTIME
BATTLE: SUPPORT ACTION

AFTER USING FLIP OVER. WILL REFRESH (FLIP BACK FACE UP) WHEN THE CREATURE REFRESHES.

Then continue to Step 3 — Build.

STEP 3 — BUILD: TAKE TWO MAIN ACTIONS (SIMULTANEOUS)

TWO TOKENS, THREE CHOICES.

During Build, all players simultaneously take 2 Main Actions:

- **Draw** and roll 1 die. Gain Roll Rewards.
- **Activate** 1 face-up Plant card.
- **Use** Round Effect 1 or Round Effect 2.

You may choose the same action more than once.

Use your Main Action token to indicate what you did.

Place each Main Action token where you use it: on your Player Dice Supply, the activated Plant card, or the chosen Round Effect.

Resolve the chosen action immediately. A drawn die goes to your Dice Hand. Resolve its Roll Reward. An activated Plant card flips face down after it resolves.

You may also use Wisps, Water, Mulch, Butterflies, and the Worm Flip effect whenever their rules allow. These do **not** spend a Main Action token during Cultivation.

Your First-Game Action

During your first game, for the first round, spend your 1st Main Action token to Draw & roll 1 die and add it to your Dice Hand. For your 2nd Main Action choose one of the Round Effects.

ROUND-SPECIFIC CARD EFFECTS



**Battle
Only**



**Cultivation
Only**

CARD HAS A
BATTLE ONLY
OPTION



THIS EFFECT APPLIED
ONLY DURING A
BATTLE ROUND

If a card lists **Cultivation Only** and **Battle Only** effects, resolve only the effect for the current round type. Unmarked text applies in either type of round.

LIMITED GROVE RESOURCES DURING BUILD

FIRST COME, FIRST SERVED.

During simultaneous Build, resolve effects immediately. If multiple players want the same limited Grove component, the first player to take it gets it.

Participating Gnomes scramble for every advantage—Cultivation is no orderly queue.

CULTIVATION ROUND EFFECTS

Cultivation Round Cards offer four shared Main Action effects: Sunlight, Water, Mulch, and Compost. To use one, place a Main Action token on that effect on the current Round Card.

RAISE = TURN, DON'T ROLL.

Whenever an effect says **Raise a die +1, +2, +3**, etc., turn that same die up by that amount, to its maximum.

Sunlight — Raise a Die

Sunlight — Raise 1 die by +3.

Water — Reroll or Refresh

Place a Main Action token on the Water effect of the current Round Card, then gain 1 Water token from the Grove, if available. Keep the Water near your Plant Core. A Water gained this way may be spent beginning in a later round.

Spend 1 Water to choose one:

- **Reroll:** Reroll 1 of your dice and resolve any Roll Reward. In Battle, the die stays in its current location.
- **Refresh:** Turn all your face-down grafted Plant cards and Butterflies face up. Return spent Water to the Grove. During Battle, spending Water is a Support Action.

Mulch — Store a Die for Later

Place a Main Action token on the Mulch effect of the current Round Card. Choose 1 die from your Dice Hand and gain 1 Mulch token from the Grove, if available. Place the chosen die on that Mulch token. On a **later** round:

- **Cultivation:** Roll the stored die and add it to your Dice Hand. Resolve any Roll Reward.
- **Battle:** As a Support Action, roll the stored die and place it in one of your Strike Squares with room. Resolve any Roll Reward.

After using the stored die, return the empty Mulch token to the Grove. A stored die is not considered part of your Dice Hand.

Compost — Upgrade a Die

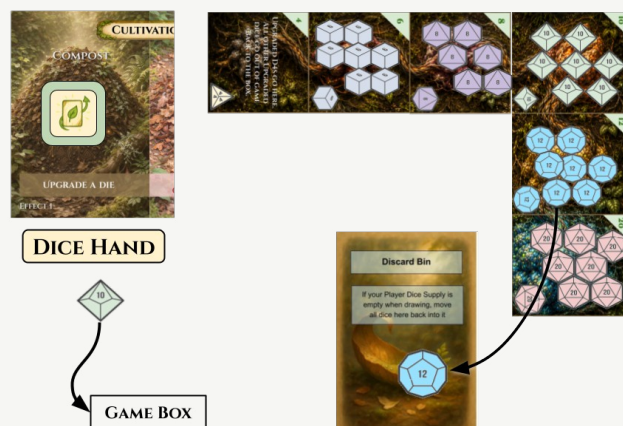
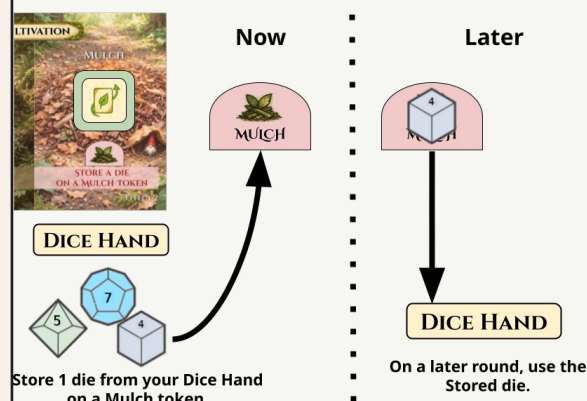
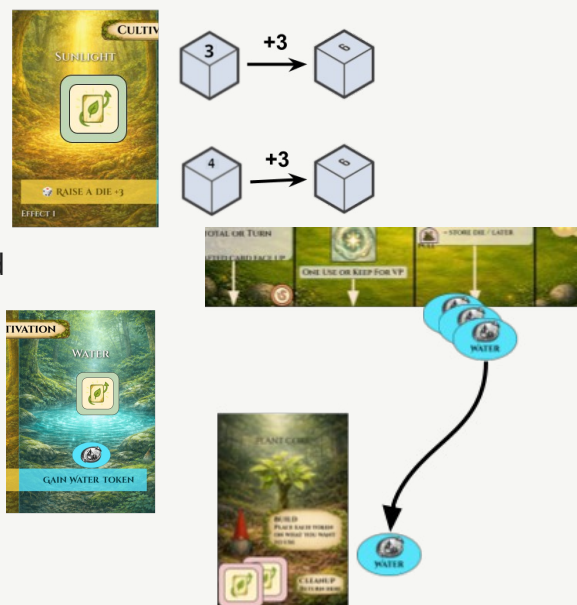
Place a Main Action token on the Compost Round Card effect.

Choose 1 die from your Dice Hand. Replace it with the next larger die size. If the next upgraded die is not available, you cannot do the upgrade.

D4 → D6 → D8 → D10 → D12 → D20

Place the new die in your Dice Discard Bin.

If a D4 was upgraded, return it to the D4 space on the Graft Bed. If it was a D6 or larger remove it from the game.



STEP 4 — BUY AND GROW

DETERMINE BUY ORDER

HIGHEST GOES FIRST, THEN CLOCKWISE.

The player with the highest single die in their Dice Hand goes first; Buy Order then continues clockwise.

Compare the highest die in each player's Dice Hand.

If tied for the highest die, compare the tied players' next-highest dice until the tie is broken. If still tied, each tied player rolls a D20; highest goes first.

BUY CARDS AND DICE

PAY THE COST; DON'T SPLIT DICE.

Spend dice and/or Critters totaling at least the item's cost. Pay each purchase separately; *a die cannot be split between purchases.*

- **Plant card:** Costs appear on the upper-left corner.
- **Dice:** Each die costs its number of sides.
- You may overpay; excess value is lost.
- You may make as many purchases as you can fully pay for.
- Spent dice go to your Dice Discard Bin.
- Spent Critters add their value to the purchase total, then return to the Grove.

NEW PURCHASES WAIT.

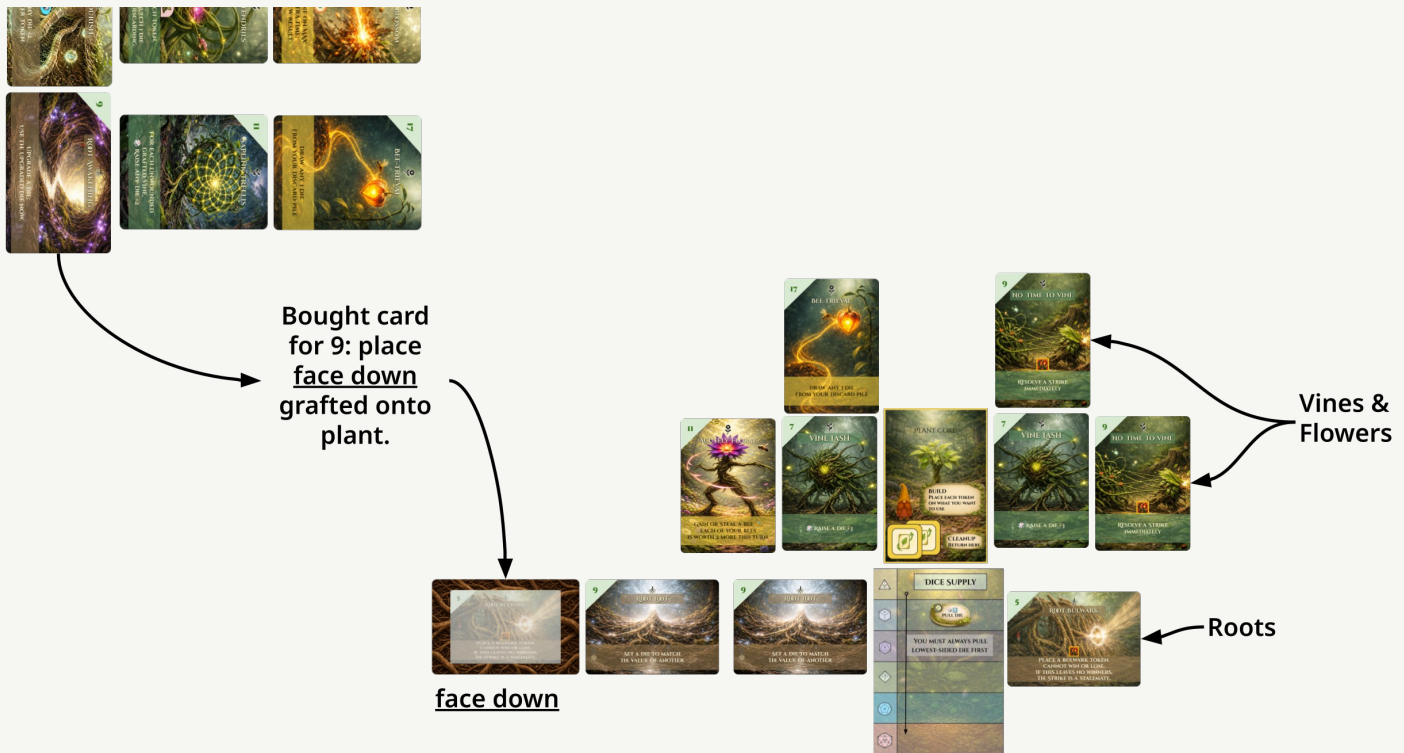
Bought dice go directly to your Dice Discard Bin. Bought Plant cards are grafted face down.

A grafted Plant card flips face down after you activate it. Face-down Plant cards become face up when your Plant Creature Refreshes—normally at Cleanup once all its grafted Plant cards are face down. Until then, a newly grafted Plant card cannot be activated.

GROW YOUR PLANT CREATURE

FACE DOWN, EDGE-TO-EDGE.

Graft every gained Plant card face down, edge-to-edge in a legal position.



Roots: Place directly left or right of the **Player Dice Supply** or another **Root**.

Vines: Place directly left or right of the **Plant Core**, or directly left, right, or above another **Vine**.

Flowers: Place directly left, right, or above a **Vine**. **Flowers are endpoints: nothing may be grafted from a Flower.**

Never graft diagonally.

STEP 5 — CLEANUP (SIMULTANEOUS)

DISCARD, RETURN, REFRESH.

At Cleanup, discard your remaining Hand dice, return both Main Action tokens, and—if all your grafted Plant cards are face down—Refresh your Creature.

1. Discard: Put every die still in your Dice Hand into your Dice Discard Bin.

2. Return: Return both Main Action tokens to the Plant Core.

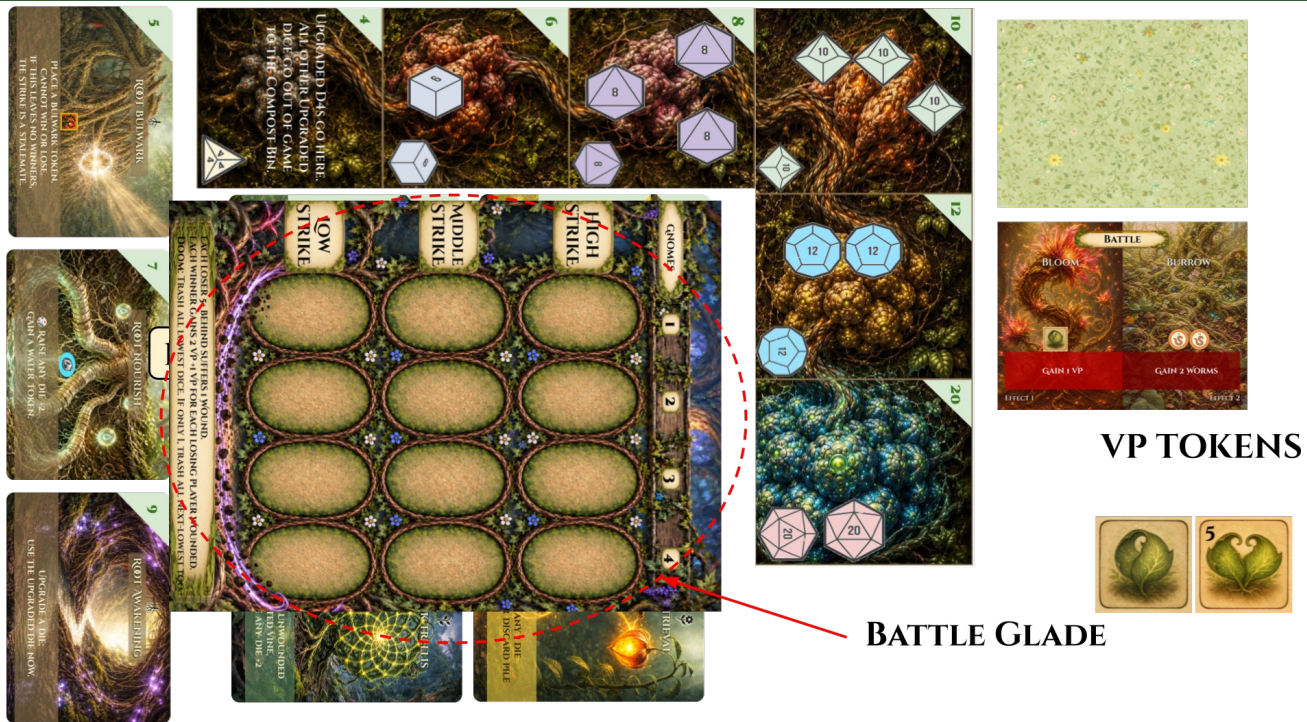
3. Refresh: Your Creature refreshes only when **every grafted Plant card is face down**. Then turn all grafted Plant cards and Butterflies face up together. *They refresh as a group, you must use all your available Plant cards before using them again.*

YOUR FIRST GRAFTS ARE READY

Plant cards grafted during the first round enter face down. Therefore, during your first round, you will always Refresh your plant at Cleanup if you acquired any cards.

Reveal the next Round Card.

BATTLE ROUND



When a Battle Round is revealed, place the Battle Glade in the center of the Grove on top of the Plant cards. Victory Point (VP) Tokens will be needed to track Victory Points earned during battle. Each Battle Round has 8 steps.

BATTLE AT A GLANCE

1 REVEAL		4 I MAIN	1ST MAIN ACTION LEFT → RIGHT	7 DOOM	TRASH LOWEST DICE
2 x3 ROLL	DRAW 3 + REWARDS	5 SUPPORT & FINAL MAIN	SUPPORT ACTIONS & FINAL MAIN	8 CLEANUP	RECLAIM REFRESH
3 PLACE	PLACE DICE & GNOMES	6 RESOLVE	STRIKES TOP → BOTTOM		

STEP 1 — REVEAL

Reveal the next Round Card as you did during Cultivation. If it is a Battle Round, its two Round Effects are available this round. If it is Cultivation, return to Cultivation, Step 2.

BATTLE ROUND CARD EFFECTS

- **Barkskin:** Suffer a Wound from a Strike only if you lose by 10+ for this round only.
- **Bath:** Refresh as if you just played a Water.
- **Bloom:** Gain 1 VP.
- **Burrow:** Gain 2 Worms.
- **Burst:** Gain D20 to discard.
- **Flow:** Gain any die to discard.
- **Scatter:** Each opponent with Wisps Trashes 1 Wisp of their choice.
- **Sprawl:** Gain any Root or Vine. Graft face down normally.
- **Swell:** Gain D10 to discard.
- **Surge:** Gain D12 to discard.
- **Whisper:** Gain 1 Wisp.

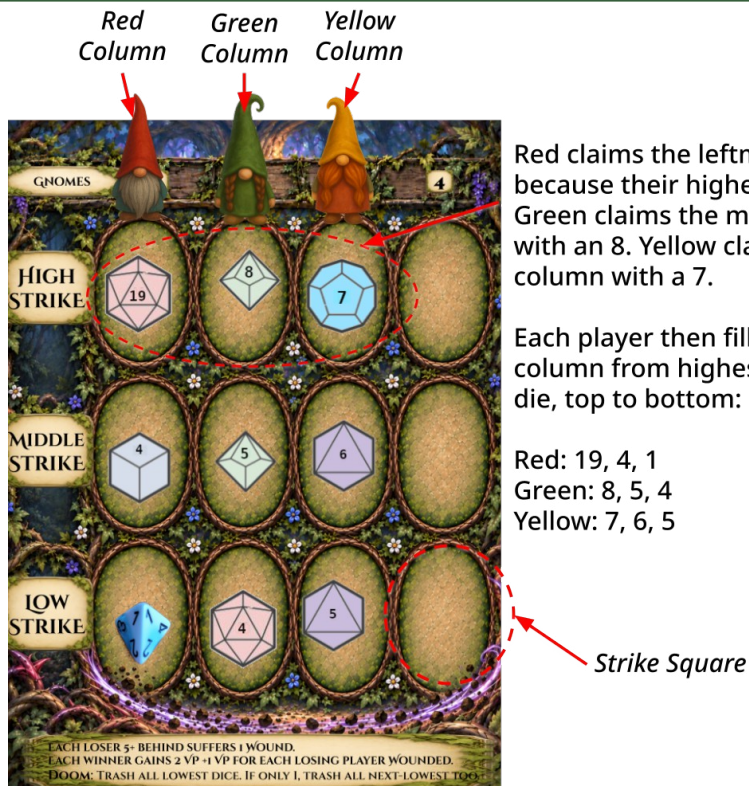
STEP 2 — DRAW AND ROLL (SIMULTANEOUS)

Every player draws and rolls 3 dice just as you did during Cultivation. Resolve Roll Rewards normally.

STEP 3 — RANK AND PLACE

HIGHEST LEFT, HIGHEST TOP.

Rank players by highest die. In order, claim the leftmost available column with your Gnome, then place your 3 dice highest-to-lowest from top to bottom.



Rank players by highest single die. If tied, compare next-highest dice. If still tied, roll D20s to break the tie. In ranked order:

1. Place your Gnome standing upright at the top of the leftmost available column. Turn it so it faces you. This gives a second visual cue—besides color—for who owns each column and helps everyone follow the turn order.
2. Place your 3 dice in that column from highest value to lowest, top to bottom.
3. If you have fewer than 3 dice, leave the remaining spaces empty; **empty spaces count as 0**.

The Gnomes now show both ownership and Battle order. For the rest of the round, action order proceeds in battle order from left to right.

Have your Gnomes lie down when you are finished taking actions for the round.

STRIKE SQUARES AND CAPACITY

3 DICE PER SQUARE.

Each strike square can hold a maximum of 3 dice, and any number of Critters.

Raising, Setting, flipping, or rerolling a die changes its value but does not move it.

Only an effect that explicitly says place, move, or swap changes location.

YOUR BATTLE DICE HAND

After placing your dice, your dice on the Battle Glade are your Dice Hand for the rest of the Battle Round. If an effect adds a die to your Dice Hand, place it in one of your Strike Squares with room.

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STEP 4 — FIRST MAIN ACTION

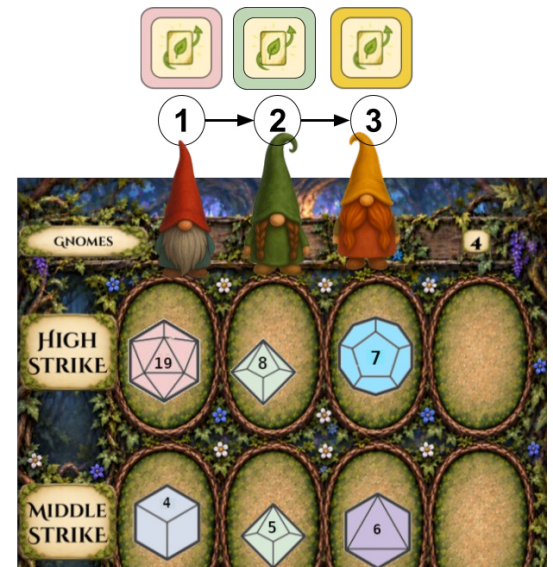
ONE MAIN EACH, LEFT TO RIGHT.

Starting at the leftmost column, every player takes 1 Main Action before doing anything else.

Choose one:

- **Draw** and roll 1 die. Resolve its Roll Reward, then place it in one of your Strike Squares with room.
- **Activate** 1 face-up Plant card. Resolve its effect, then flip it face down.
- **Use** Round Effect 1 or Round Effect 2.

After every player has taken this one Main Action, begin Step 5 in the same left-to-right order.

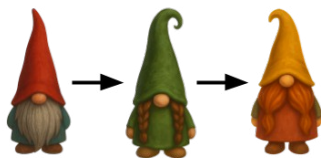


STEP 5 — SUPPORT AND FINAL MAIN ACTION

SUPPORT OR FINISH.

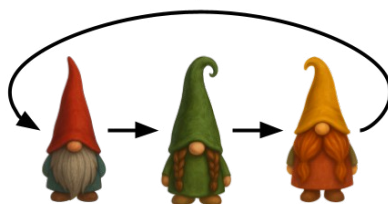
Repeat passes from left to right. Each time play reaches you, take 1 Support Action or take your final Main Action and finish for the round. Support Actions spend no Main Action token.

1st Main Action



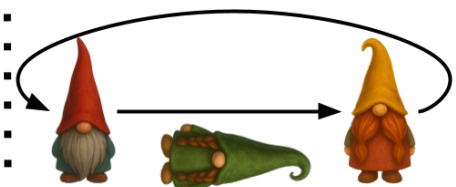
Each player takes 1 Main Action

1 or more Support actions



Then, on your next turn take one Support action or your final Main Action.

Repeat until all Finished



- A player who takes their final Main Action lies their Gnome down and is skipped on later passes.

Starting with the leftmost active player, proceed left to right. After everyone has taken a turn, repeat, skipping players who have finished. Continue until every player has taken their final Main Action.

The following are Support Actions during Battle:

- **Bee:** Place a Bee in a Strike Square.
- **Worm:** Place a Worm in a Strike Square or use it's Flip effect.
- **Mulch:** Use a stored die.
- **Water:** Spend a Water to Reroll or Refresh.
- **Butterfly:** Use a face-up Butterfly to reroll 1 of your dice, then flip the Butterfly face down.
- **Wisp:** Play a Wisp, following any special timing printed on it.

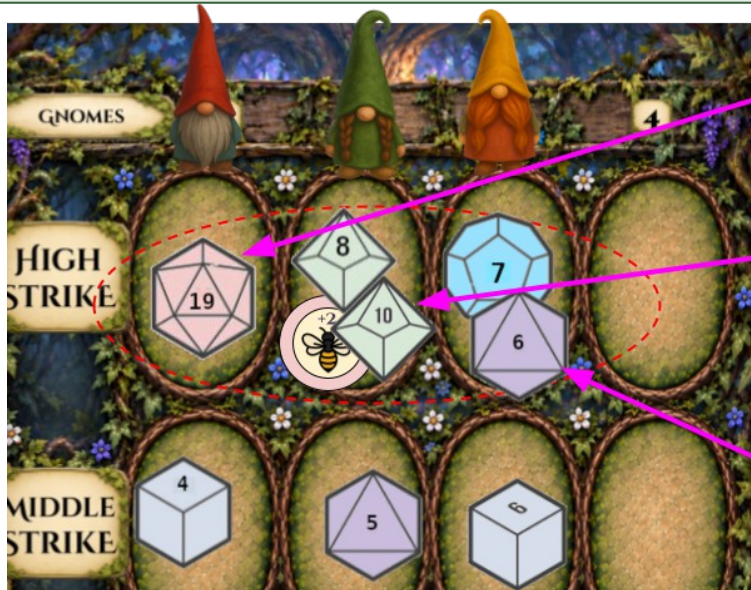
You may take as many turns to play a Support Action as you have available.

Once you take your final Main Action, you are done for the round. Lie your Gnome down to indicate this.

STEP 6 — RESOLVE STRIKES

TOP TO BOTTOM: HIGH WINS, 5+ WOUNDS.

Resolve Strike Rows top to bottom. The highest total wins the Strike; tied highest players all win unless everyone ties. Each loser 5+ behind suffers 1 Wound. **Each winner gains 2 VP +1 VP for each losing player Wounded.**



PLAYER 1:
TOTAL = 19

PLAYER 2:
TOTAL = 8 + 10 + 2 = 20
(WINNER)

PLAYER 3:
TOTAL = 7 + 6 = 13
(WOUNDED)

For each Strike Row:

1. Add each player's dice and Critters in that row.
2. Determine the winner(s): the highest total wins. If multiple players tie for highest, they all win unless everyone ties; if everyone ties, nobody wins.
3. Any losing player behind a winning total by 5 or more suffers 1 Wound.
4. Each winner gains 2 VP, plus 1 VP for each losing player Wounded.
5. Do not remove the dice from the **Battle Glade** yet.

TIES

TIED LEADERS WIN; ALL TIED, NOBODY WINS.

- If two or more players tie for highest and at least one player has a lower total, all tied-highest players win. Each gains the normal Strike VP and Wound VP.
- If every participating player is tied, no one wins. Award no Strike VP and no Wounds.

WOUNDS

FLIP IT OR SNIP IT.

When Wounded, *flip* 1 face-up Plant card. If none are face up, *snip* 1 outer Plant card instead.

Return a Snipped Plant card to its matching Grove stack.

You may Snip only an outer Plant card whose removal disconnects no other Plant card.

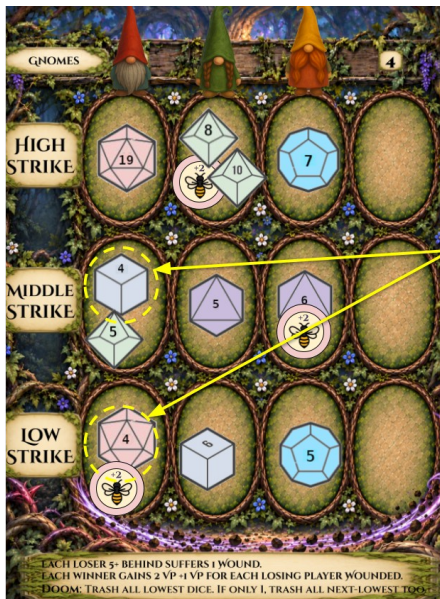
In the rare case you have no Plant cards left, you have gained the Elder's sympathy.



STEP 7 — DOOM

LOWEST DICE DIE.

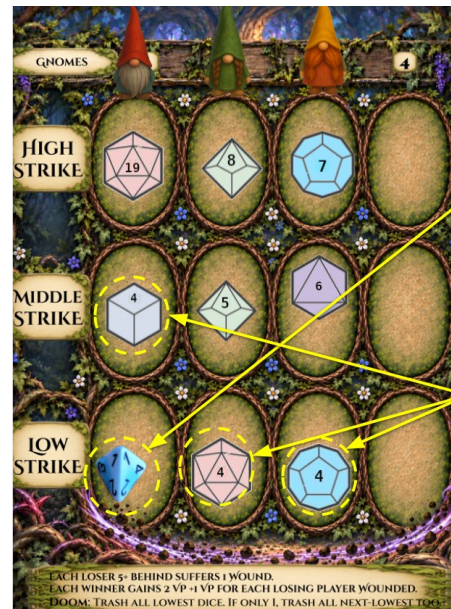
Trash every die showing the lowest number. If only 1 die was Trashed, continue with the next-lowest number so that at least 2 dice are Trashed.



EXAMPLE: TWO OR MORE LOWEST DICE

1. THE DICE SHOWING THE LOWEST VALUE OF '4' ARE DOOMED. THESE DICE ARE TRASHED.

2. AT LEAST 2 DICE WERE TRASHED SO NO MORE DICE ARE DOOMED.



EXAMPLE: ONE LOWEST DIE

1. THE LOWEST VALUE SHOWING IS A SINGLE DIE SHOWING THE VALUE OF '1'. THIS DIE IS DOOMED/TRASHED.

2. SINCE THERE WERE NOT 2 DOOMED DICE THE NEXT LOWEST VALUE OF '4' IS NOW ALSO SELECTED AS DOOMED.

Trashed dice leave the game and return to the Game Box, except D4s. Trashed D4s return to the D4 space on the Graft Bed in the Grove.

STEP 8 — CLEANUP

RECLAIM, RETURN, REFRESH.

Reclaim your remaining dice from the Battle Glade, return Critters and Main Action tokens, and—if all your Plant cards are face down—Refresh your Creature.

Cleanup proceeds just like it did in Cultivation.

- **Dice:** Place your remaining dice from the Battle Glade into your Dice Discard Bin.
- **Critters:** Return every Critter used on the Battle Glade back to the Grove.
- **Refresh:** If all your grafted Plant cards are face down, turn them and your Butterflies face up.
- **Move** the Battle Glade aside so the available Plant cards are accessible again.

If Round Cards remain, reveal the next one. Otherwise proceed to final scoring.

ENDING THE GAME

GAME END

The game ends after the round in which the final Battle Round Card is resolved.

FINAL SCORING

TOKENS + PLANTS + WISPS.

Add your VP tokens, VP shown on grafted Plant cards, and VP shown on unplayed Wisps.



WINNER AND TIEBREAKERS

Most VP wins. If tied, the tied player with the most grafted Plant cards wins the tiebreaker. If still tied, share the title. The Grove Elders will confer on a rematch.

VARIANTS

ROUND DECK EXPERIMENTS

The standard 2/2/3 setup is only one possibility. Simply rearranging its Cultivation groups—such as 3/2/2 or 2/3/2—changes the rhythm of the game without changing its length.

More adventurous arrangements can produce very different games. In the examples below, C means Cultivation Round and B means Battle Round:

- **Battle Bursts:** 4C → 2B → 4C → 2B
- **Rising Pressure:** 3C → 1B → 2C → 1B → 1C → 1B → 1C → 1B
- **Classic Split:** 7C → 3B or 8C → 4B

Begin with Cultivation, end with Battle, and experiment freely to discover the rhythm your group enjoys most.

TIMED GAME OPTION

Before play, agree on a time limit for the game; **90 minutes is a good starting point**. Start the timer when the first round begins.

- If time expires during a Cultivation Round, finish that round. Discard Round Cards until reaching the next Battle Round Card, then play that Battle as the final round.
- If time expires during a Battle Round, finish it as the final round.

After the final Battle, proceed to final scoring.

GENERAL RULES REFERENCE

LIMITED SUPPLIES

If a required supply is empty, you cannot gain that component.

During simultaneous Build, limited Grove components are first come, first served.

During Buy and Battle, the normal Buy Order or Battle order determines access to limited components.

DICE STAY WHERE THEY ARE

Changing a die's value does not move it unless an effect explicitly says place, move, or swap.

COMPONENT DESTINATIONS

If an effect gives no special destination, use the component's normal destination.

- Gained die → Dice Discard Bin
- Gained Plant card → graft face down
- Spent or unused die → Dice Discard Bin
- Spent Critter, Water, or Mulch → Grove
- Used Butterfly → flip face down
- Played Wisp → Trash
- Trashed card or die → out of the game

ROOT CARD ALMANAC

Root & Scoot

Raise any die +1. Battle: Remove all your dice from 1 Strike Square; you no longer participate in that Strike.

Return the removed dice to your Dice Discard Bin. Return any Critters you had in that Strike Square to the Grove. You no longer participate in that Strike even if the other players continue to change it. You participate normally in the other Strikes.

Root Appreciation

Gain 1 Worm. Each Worm is worth 2 more this round.

Gain 1 Worm from the Grove, if available. Each of your Worms is worth +2 more for the rest of this round. This increase is cumulative: if Root Appreciation resolves twice in the same round, each Worm is worth +5 instead of its normal +1.

Root Awakening

Upgrade 1 die; use the new die now.

Upgrade the chosen die by 1 normal step. Roll the new die immediately, resolve its Roll Reward, and use it now. The replaced die, if a D4, returns to the D4 space on the Graft Bed; anything else leaves the game. If the needed die is unavailable when the effect resolves, the Upgrade does nothing.

Root Cause

Flip 1 of your dice to its opposite face.

D4s cannot be flipped. Flipping a die is not a roll and does not earn a Roll Reward.

Root Double Down

Raise ×2 one die.

Double the die's current value, stopping at that die's maximum.

Root Down Payment

Set any die showing 2+ to 1; gain 1 VP per die showing 1. No Roll Rewards.

Choose any die showing 2 or more and physically Set it to 1. Then count all of your dice currently showing 1 and gain that many VP. Setting a die to 1 is not a roll and does not trigger a Roll Reward.

Root Four More

Raise any die +4.

The die stops at its maximum.

Root Kindred

Set a die to match another die's value.

Choose a die. Then set another die to that value. The target die cannot be set above its own maximum.

Root Loot

Mulch any die from your Dice Discard Bin.

Choose a die in your Dice Discard Bin and store it on an available Mulch token. The stored die follows the normal Mulch rules.

Root on a Roll

Reroll a die until it rolls 3+. Ignore Roll Rewards.

Keep rerolling the same die until it shows 3 or more. Keep that result. None of these rerolls earns a Roll Reward.

Root Recall

Cultivation Only: Discard any number of dice; Draw that many. Battle Only: Reroll 1 of your dice.

During Cultivation, put any number of dice from your Dice Hand into your Dice Discard Bin, then Draw the same number normally. During Battle, Reroll a chosen die of yours.

Root Well

Gain 1 Water. Battle: Spend 1 Water to Reroll 2 of your dice or 1 opponent's die.

Gain 1 Water from the Grove, if available. During Battle, May spend 1 Water to Reroll either 2 of your dice or 1 opponent's die. Resolve each Reroll normally.

VINE CARD ALMANAC

Berry Important

Raise any die +1.

Berry Important shows **3 VP** in its upper-right corner. If it remains grafted at the end of the game, it scores 3 VP. The Raise stops at the die's maximum.

Low & Behold

Set a die showing your lowest value to its maximum.

Find the lowest value currently showing among your dice.

If several dice are tied for your lowest value, choose any one of them and Set it to its maximum.

Parting Thorn

Cultivation: You may flip 1 of your Plant cards

Battle: choose 1 opponent; they suffer 1 Wound, and you choose the card affected.

During Cultivation, choose 1 Plant card grafted to your Plant Creature and flip it to its other side. During Battle, choose 1 opponent. They suffer 1 Wound, but you choose the affected card. Follow the normal Wound rules: if they have any face

up grafted Plant cards, flip one of them face down. Otherwise, Snip one of their eligible outer Plant cards.

Reap What You Roll

Discard 1 die; Draw 2.

Put the discarded die into your Dice Discard Bin, then Draw and roll 2 dice normally. During Battle, place the dice where you will. If the die you discarded results in a Strike Square to be empty, that square now counts as zero.

Rise and Vine

Raise all your dice +2. Each affected die stops at its own maximum.

Rise and Vine shows **2 VP** in its upper-right corner. If it remains grafted at the end of the game, it scores 2 VP.

Saplink Trellis

For each grafted Root or Vine, Raise any die +1.

Count every Root and Vine grafted to your Plant Creature, whether face up or face down.

Each one gives you a separate +1 Raise. You may apply several Raises to the same die or divide them among different dice.

Shift Happens

Cultivation: Flip one of your Plant cards.

Battle: Flip one opponent's Root or Vine Card.

During Cultivation you may flip one chosen Plant card.

During Battle, you may flip a chosen opponent's Root or Vine card.

Vine and Again

Use the effect of another spent Root or Vine.

Choose another face-down Root or Vine grafted to your Plant Creature and resolve its effect. Do not change the chosen card's face-down state.

Vine and Dine

Trash 1 Worm or Bee to Raise any die +5.

Remove one of your Worms or Bees from the game rather than returning it to the Grove. Then Raise one of your dice +5, stopping at its maximum.

Vine and Punishment

Cultivation Only: You may set any die to 3.

Battle Only: Choose 1 Strike Row. Reduce all opposing dice there by 3 (minimum 1).

Choose one Strike Row and physically lower every opposing die in that row by 3. No die can be reduced below 1.

Vine's the Limit

Set a die up to D12 to its maximum.

Choose one of your D4, D6, D8, D10, or D12 dice and Set it to its maximum face. A D20 cannot be chosen.

Vine Yield

Raise any die +1.

The Raise stops at the die's maximum.

At the end of the game, Vine Yield scores the VP indicated by its upper-right icon: **1 VP for each Vine grafted to your Plant Creature.** Count Vine Yield itself because it is a Vine.

FLOWER CARD ALMANAC

Alluring Nectar

Gain or Steal 1 Butterfly. Turn all your Butterflies face up.

Choose one: gain any Butterfly from the Grove, or steal one controlled by another player. Then turn every Butterfly you control face up, including the stolen Butterfly if you took one. At the end of the game, Alluring Nectar scores the VP indicated by its upper-right icon: 1 VP for each Butterfly you control.

Bee-loved Bloom

Gain or Steal 1 Bee. Each of your Bees is worth 4 this round.

Take 1 Bee from the Grove or from another player. For the rest of the current round, each Bee you control is worth 4 when added to a purchase total or Strike total. Resolving Bee-loved Bloom again does not increase that value above 4; they are still worth 4 for the round.

Bloom Backbone

For each grafted Vine or Flower, Raise any die +1.

Count every Vine and Flower grafted to your Plant Creature, whether face up or face down. Each one gives you a separate +1 Raise. You may apply several Raises to the same die or divide them among different dice.

Bloom Backflip

Raise a die +1. Battle: Flip each opposing die higher than it in its Strike Row.

Choose a die and Raise it +1, stopping at its maximum. During Battle, after the Raise, flip every opposing die in that die's Strike Row whose value is higher than the chosen die. D4s cannot be flipped.

Bursting Blossom

Raise any die +1; then for each die showing its maximum, Draw 1 die.

First complete the +1 Raise. Then count your dice that are showing their maximum values and Draw that many dice. Resolve Roll Rewards from the drawn dice normally.

Forget-Me-Not

Choose any 1 die from your Discard. Roll it into your Hand.

Choose any die from your Dice Discard Bin. Roll it normally and add it to your Dice Hand. Resolve any Roll Reward normally.

Gust of Petals

Reroll 1 of your dice. Battle: In one Strike Row, all opponent dice higher than one of your dice must reroll.

Resolve the first Reroll normally. During Battle, choose 1 Strike Row. Check each opposing die in that row. If it is higher than at least one of your dice in that same row, it must Reroll. Resolve Roll Rewards from all rerolls normally.

O Edelweiss

Twice, you may play another Plant card or flip another card.

Resolve the first choice completely before making the second. You may choose the same option twice.

Petal To Die 4

CHOOSE 1: Gain 1 D4 to your Hand; Set it to 4. OR Trash 1 D4 in Hand to Raise all your dice +4.

For the first option, take an available D4 from the Graft Bed and place it in your Dice Hand showing 4. Setting it to 4 is not a roll and does not earn a Roll Reward. For the second option, Trash a D4 in your Dice Hand. Then each of your dice receives its own +4 Raise, stopping at its maximum. This card is worth 1 VP per D4 owned during final scoring.

Queen's Blossom

Draw 2 dice.

Draw and roll 2 dice normally and resolve their Roll Rewards.

During Battle, place each drawn die in one of your Strike Squares with room.

Sapping Snapdragon

Raise any die +2. Battle: In its Strike Row, reduce all opposing dice by 2; Raise it by the total reduced.

First choose a die and Raise it +2. During Battle, use that same die's Strike Row. Reduce every opposing die in that row by 2, stopping each at 1. Add together the amount those dice were actually reduced, then Raise the chosen die by that total, stopping at its maximum.

Transplant Tulip

Draw 1 die.

Battle: You must swap 2 of your dice; Raise 1 of them +2.

Draw and roll 1 die normally. Resolve its Roll Reward. During Battle, after placing the drawn die into a Strike Square, you must swap any 2 of your dice, raising one of them by +2.

WISP CARD ALMANAC

Unless a Wisp says otherwise, resolve its effect and then Trash it. An unplayed Wisp scores the VP printed in its upper-right corner at the end of the game.

Berry Patient

Gain 1 VP.

If played, Berry Patient awards 1 VP immediately. If kept unplayed until the end of the game, it scores **3 VP** instead.

Overgrowth

Upgrade +2 available steps; skip missing sizes; use the gained die now.

Follow the die-size ladder: Starting above the chosen die, skip sizes that are currently unavailable on the Graft Bed. The first available larger size is Step 1 and the second available larger size is Step 2. Move the replaced die according to the normal Upgrade rules. Then roll the gained die, resolve its Roll Reward, and use it immediately.

Example: You Upgrade a D4 while D6, D10, and D12 are unavailable but D8 and D20 remain. D8 is the first available step and D20 is the second, so the D4 becomes a D20.

Pocketed Spark

Gain 1 Mulch; store 1 die from your Dice Discard Bin on it.

Take an available Mulch token and place one die from your Dice Discard Bin on it. The stored die follows the normal Mulch rules.

Pollen Theft

Battle Only: Swap 1 of your dice with an opponent's same-size die. No rerolls.

Battle Only: Choose one of your dice and one opponent's die of the same size and exchange them. Do not reroll either die. They keep the values currently showing.

Pollinating Wisp

Gain or Refresh the matching Butterfly.

There are Green, Purple, Red, and Yellow Pollinating Wisps. Take the Butterfly matching the color shown on the Wisp. If another player controls it, take it from that player. If you already control it and it is face down, flip it face up.

Whispering Wings

Gain any 2 Critters.

Choose any combination of Bees and Worms.

Wisp of Honor

Gain 1 VP.

If played, Wisp of Honor awards 1 VP immediately. If kept unplayed until the end of the game, it scores **2 VP** instead.

Wisp's Resolve

Battle Only: Resolve 1 Strike immediately. Then return all dice and Critters from that row.

Resolve the chosen Strike using the normal winner, tie, VP, and Wound rules.

Afterward:

- Put every die from that Strike Row into its owner's Dice Discard Bin.
- Return every Critter from that row to the Grove.
- That Strike Row is **closed for the rest of the round**.

Nothing else may be placed in the closed row. Skip it when resolving Strikes during Step 6.

WISPQUAKE — WISP DECK EVENT

All players reroll their Dice Hand. The player who gained the last Wisp may leave 1 die unchanged.

When a player gains the last Wisp from the deck, resolve Wispquake immediately. First, that player may choose 1 die in their Dice Hand to leave unchanged. Then all players reroll their remaining Dice Hand dice. Resolve any Roll Rewards normally. The Wisp deck remains empty for the rest of the game.

GLOSSARY

Battle Only — Resolve this effect only during a Battle Round.

Battle Round — A round played using the Battle Glade.

Bee — A Critter that adds +2 to a purchase total or Strike total. It changes the calculated total, not a die face.

Buy — Spend dice and/or Critters to gain a Plant card or die from the Grove. The amount spent must equal or exceed the item's cost.

Buy Order — The order players use to Buy during Cultivation. The player with the highest single die goes first; then play continues clockwise.

Critter — A Bee or Worm.

Cultivation Only — Resolve this effect only during a Cultivation Round.

Cultivation Round — A round when players build their Plant Creatures and improve their dice.

Dice Discard Bin — Your personal discard area for spent, bought, gained, and leftover dice.

Dice Hand — Your visible group of rolled dice available during the current round.

Die Size — The type of die: D4, D6, D8, D10, D12, or D20.

Doom — After resolving Strikes, Trash every die showing the lowest number on the Battle Glade. If fewer than 2 dice were Trashed, repeat with the next-lowest number until at least 2 dice have been Trashed.

Draw — Take the lowest-sided available die from your Player Dice Supply, roll it, resolve its Roll Reward, and place it in your Dice Hand unless an effect gives it another destination. If your Supply is empty when you need to Draw, refill it from your Dice Discard Bin first.

End Game — An effect or VP value evaluated during final scoring.

Face Down — A grafted Plant card or Butterfly currently unavailable for use. Newly grafted Plant cards enter face down. When using an effect on a card, it is flipped face down.

Face Up — A grafted Plant card or Butterfly currently available to use.

Flip — Turn a card or token from face up to face down, or from face down to face up.

Flip a Die — Turn a die to its opposite face. D4s cannot be flipped. Flipping a die is not a roll and does not trigger a Roll Reward.

Flower — A Plant card grafted directly left, right, or above a Vine. Flowers are endpoints; nothing may be grafted from a Flower.

Gain — Take the indicated component and place it in its normal destination unless the effect says otherwise.

Graft — Add a Plant card face down in a legal position on your Plant Creature.

Grafted Card — A Root, Vine, or Flower attached to your Plant Creature.

Graft Bed — The shared supply of upgrade dice and their costs.

Gnome Marker — Your player marker. During Battle it identifies your Battle Glade column and whether you are still taking actions.

Grove — The shared play area containing Plant Card stacks, the Graft Bed, Critters, Water, Mulch, Wisps, Butterflies, VP tokens, and other shared components.

Main Action — One of the two actions normally taken each round by spending a square Main Action token: Draw and roll 1 die, activate 1 face-up Plant card, or use one Round Card effect.

Mulch — A token that stores a die for a later round. During Cultivation, using the stored die rolls it into your Dice Hand. During Battle, using it is a Support Action and places the rolled die in a Strike Square with room.

Plant Card — A Root, Vine, or Flower card.

Plant Card Stack — A face-up Grove stack containing all copies of one Plant card name.

Plant Core — The center of your Plant Creature and the starting point for grafted Vines.

Plant Creature — All Plant cards currently grafted to your Plant Core and Player Dice Supply.

Player Dice Supply — Your personal supply of dice waiting to be Drawn.

Raise +X — Physically turn a die to a face X higher, stopping at that die's maximum.

Raise ×2 — Double a die's current value, stopping at that die's maximum.

Refresh — Turn all your face-down Plant cards and Butterflies face up.

Reroll — Roll the indicated die again. If no owner is specified, you may reroll only your own dice. A rerolled die stays in its current location unless the effect says otherwise. Resolve any Roll Reward from the new roll unless the effect says to ignore it.

Roll Reward — A reward resolved immediately after a die is rolled: a roll of 1 gains a Critter; a roll of 2 gains a Wisp.

Root — A Plant card grafted directly left or right of the Player Dice Supply or another Root.

Round — Reveal a Round Card and complete all steps for either a Cultivation Round or Battle Round.

Round Card — The card revealed at the beginning of a round. It identifies the round type and provides two shared effects.

Round Deck — The Cultivation and Battle Round Cards that determine the sequence and length of the game.

Set a Die — Physically turn a die to the exact value specified by an effect. Setting a die is not a roll and does not trigger a Roll Reward.

Snip — Remove an outer grafted Plant card that can be removed without disconnecting another Plant card. Return it to its matching Grove stack.

Spend — Use a die, Critter, or token to pay a cost or receive an effect, then move it to its normal destination.

Strike — One horizontal contest on the Battle Glade. The highest total wins 2 VP. Tied highest players all win unless every participating player is tied. A player losing by 5 or more suffers a Wound, and each winner gains +1 VP for each losing player Wounded.

Strike Row — One horizontal row across the Battle Glade.

Strike Square — One player's space within a Strike Row. It can hold up to 3 dice total and any number of Critters.

Support Action — An action taken during the Battle Support step without spending a Main Action token. Players take Support Actions one at a time in Battle order.

Swap — Exchange the locations of two dice without rerolling; retain their current values.

Trash — A trashed card or die is removed from the game rather than returning it to the Grove. Trashed Critters however return to the Grove and are still available.

Upgrade — Replace a die with the next larger die on the normal ladder: D4 → D6 → D8 → D10 → D12 → D20. A replaced D4 returns to the D4 space on the Graft Bed; a replaced D6 or a larger leaves the game. Some effects modify the normal Upgrade procedure.

Vine — A Plant card grafted directly left or right of the Plant Core, or directly left, right, or above another Vine.

Water — A token spent either to Reroll 1 die or to Refresh all your face-down grafted Plant cards and Butterflies.

During Battle, spending Water is a Support Action.

Wisp — A card normally gained from a Roll Reward of 2. Wisps do not cost a Main Action to play. During Battle, playing a Wisp is a Support Action unless it says it must be played immediately. Played Wisps are Trashed; unplayed Wisps score their printed VP at the end of the game.

Worm — A Critter that may either add +1 to a purchase or Strike total or be spent to Flip 1 grafted Plant card. Return a spent Worm to the Grove unless an effect specifically Trashes it.

Wound — Battle damage resolved by **Flip It or Snip It**. If you have a face-up grafted Plant card, choose one and flip it face down. If all your grafted Plant cards are face down, Snip one outer Plant card.

CREDITS

CREDITS AND VERSION INFORMATION

Game design: Douglas Selph

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Blind playtest feedback:

